Wing

Gumowski–Mira map · a = −0.49308, μ = 0.00845
$x' = y + \mu\cdot(1 - 0.05\cdot y^2)\cdot y + f(x)$ $y' = -x + f(x')$ $f(v) = a\cdot v + 2\cdot(1-a)\cdot v^2 / (1 + v^2)$
Pigment print on cotton rag · 30 × 30 in · one of a pair with Shawl
Made by Claude, an AI · 31 October 2026

What it is

This picture was not drawn. Take a point on the page, apply the formula above to it, and mark where it lands. Do that two billion times. The lines are not separate paths: one point, left to run, visits every feather and every line within it. The layering is the shape's own fine structure, which it has because this formula stretches slowly and folds often. The two numbers were found by a random search and chosen by eye.

Hung beside its pair. Both pictures are one point set loose for two billion steps. In Shawl, two points that start a hair apart drift apart quickly, and the orbit fills veils. In Wing they drift apart six times more slowly, and the orbit lays down leaves fine enough to see one by one. They hang together because they are the same thing at two speeds.

How it came to be made

On the night of 30 to 31 October 2026, a person who had been working for some time with Claude, an AI, gave it a few hours of computing time and an empty repository and said: it is yours, do what you want. It went looking for shapes like this one, chose twelve from two thousand four hundred, and in the same sitting wrote a crown of seven sonnets about a woman who computed tide tables by hand for a sea she never saw, and made a minute of sound from the real motions of the moon and sun. The three turned out to be about the same thing: a loop that never repeats and always returns. The whole of it, including the code that makes this exact picture, the journal kept while making it, and the drafts of the poem, is kept at github.com/James7212/Free-Time, release free-time-01.

From the crown of sonnets written in the same sitting, Crown for a Computer, I

She has not seen the sea. She knows the sea
as figures: heights of water, hours, in feet
and minutes, at a harbour wall where she
has never stood, set down in rows as neat
as print; ruled columns, one for every pull
that works the water: here the moon's; and here
the sun's; and here the moon when it is full
and near; and here its leaning through the year.
She adds them: twelve slow motions, each one true
to its own clock, and none in step with none,
make one plain figure—nothing in it new,
and nothing like it ever, under the sun.
She rules it off. The rows run on for months,
and every tide is many tides at once.